

24, The Advantages and Disadvantages of Western Expansion, and the Problem of Pseudo-modernization

For the Islamic world—or more bluntly, for all nations excluding Europe and Japan—the absolute greatest fortune and simultaneously the most catastrophic misfortune was that the West, having ultimately transcended the Middle Ages and marched toward early modern civilization, could not possibly remain stagnant in its corner of the Eurasian landmass. Beginning in the 16th century, Europeans projected their influence with exponentially increasing intensity across the entire globe.

It was a fortune because Europeans brought advanced technology, ideologies, and political systems. For other relatively backward regions, these imported elements, at the very least, superficially appeared capable of propelling local societies forward. It was an explicit misfortune because Western influence (*particularly regarding weaponry, administrative systems, and economic apparatuses*) completely and violently amputated the spontaneous historical trajectories of these regions! (*This primarily refers to the **feudalization** process; for exceptionally primitive regions where generating civilization itself was a Herculean task, such interruption was largely irrelevant*).

Under these novel influences, the power of the central government relative to the localities multiplied astronomically. Consequently, we bear witness to a grotesque phenomenon: vast expanses of the globe find themselves trapped in a state of **Pseudo-modernization** (伪近/现代化)! State power is rapidly compounding, yet the society as a whole has never undergone the exhaustive reorganization dictated by a complete **feudal** stage. The fundamental institutions and ideologies prerequisite for supporting early modern civilization are entirely absent.

The inorganic growth of state **infrastructural power** inevitably birthed an even more formidable **despotic power** (*since no societal mechanism existed to constrain it*). Society structurally lacked the conditions to internalize modern scientific thought, rendering it impossible for these nations to keep pace with Western technological advancement. In response, autocrats became increasingly inclined to amplify systematic exploitation to augment the power they could directly control.

For example, we can observe with absolute clarity the exact dynamics that unfolded within the Mughal Empire and the Ottoman Empire. Despite their **feudalization** having fundamentally never reached its requisite climax—namely, a feudal apparatus analogous to the European Middle Ages—the increasingly conspicuous Western influence in the 16th century triggered a massive "ebb tide" (退潮) in the feudalization of both empires!

During the reign of Emperor Akbar (阿克巴皇帝) of the Mughal Empire, a bureaucratic hierarchical system known as the **Mansabdar system** (曼萨布达尔制 / referring to the holder of a *mansab*) emerged, comprising approximately 33 distinct ranks. Although, theoretically, a Mansabdar could still be granted a *Jagir* (now referred to as a *Mansab*), the Mansabdar system had intrinsically mutated into a rigid bureaucratic hierarchy. Different ranks of Mansabdars possessed varying degrees of power, status, and income. In stark contrast, the hierarchical classification of former *Iqta* holders was traditionally correlated strictly with the scale of military service provided.

The rule permitting the hereditary transmission of the *Jagirdar*, which had developed earlier during the Delhi Sultanate period, was systematically abolished under the Mansabdar system! The Mughal emperor monopolized the absolute power to grant, reduce, or entirely confiscate a Mansabdar's *Mansab*, exercising direct, unmediated control over this entire aristocracy.

Simultaneously, a feudal military benefice system known as the **Timar** (蒂马尔) emerged in the Ottoman Empire, held by cavalymen known as the **Sipahi** (西帕希 / Spahi). In exactly parallel fashion, the *Timar* explicitly prohibited hereditary succession; absolute ownership of the land remained vested in the Sultan, and what was granted was merely the *usufruct* (收益权 / revenue rights). However, the holder of a *Timar* was permitted to employ professionals to assist in managing the fiefdom, as they possessed a degree of administrative authority and exercised partial police powers. If proper governance resulted in an increase in land cultivation and population, they were rewarded; if the land was abandoned, they faced punitive measures. This tightly intertwined the personal honor and disgrace of the *Sipahi* with the very land he governed.

From this highly specific perspective, the degree of **feudalization** in the Ottoman Empire might have been marginally higher than that of the Mughal Empire. However, in essence, there was virtually zero fundamental difference. The Ottoman Sultan retained the capacity to revoke and redistribute land at will, deploying an exceptionally labyrinthine supervisory apparatus to investigate and distribute the *Timars*. The Ottoman Empire had already become hyper-bureaucratized! The situation of the Safavid Empire (萨菲帝国), viewed macroscopically, did not differ from its two contemporaries; Western scholars frequently prefer to categorize these three regimes into a single typology.

In my view, the problem of "**Pseudo-modernization**" remains irrevocably the single most severe international crisis of contemporary society—bar none! Anyone sketching the geopolitical map of all developed nations and regions today will effortlessly recognize this undeniable reality: they consist exclusively of European nations, Japan, and the colonies forged during the Age of Discovery.

The absolute foundation of early modernization was precisely the institutions, organizations, social contracts, and concepts forged in the crucible of the entire developmental process of the **feudal system** over Europe's millennium-long Middle Ages. For all other nations that failed to complete this entire feudal process, what conceivable method exists under current conditions to "make up for the missed lessons" (把缺的课给补上)? After all, in today's era, it is fundamentally impossible to force these backward nations to replay the entire **feudalization** process from scratch. To date, no one on earth has proposed a satisfactory paradigm.

However, I must explicitly point out here: our nation fundamentally does not belong to those Afro-Asian countries that became universally "unfortunate" strictly due to the emergence of Western influence. For India and Turkey, if we hypothesize that European influence had never existed, and they were granted sufficient time, the historical trajectory strongly indicates an overwhelming probability that their **feudalization** processes would have continued to develop.

China is fundamentally different! The chronological point at which China mutated into a hyper-stable **restoration-bureaucratic state** (复辟官僚国家) occurred eons before Western influence ever arrived! **This equates to China having committed societal suicide phenomenally early; all outsiders could subsequently do was flog the corpse (鞭尸)—no one could murder it a second time!**

If anything rendered the already catastrophically unfortunate Chinese people even more unfortunate, it could only possibly be Soviet Russia, rather than Western nations in the conventional sense.

24, 西方扩张的利与弊, 以及伪近代化问题

对于伊斯兰世界, 或者干脆说除了欧洲和日本的所有国家来说最大的幸运和不幸都是一个最终走出中世纪走向近现代文明的西方不可能还待在欧亚大陆的角落里不动, 从 16 世纪开始, 欧洲人将其影响越来越强地扩张到了全世界。说幸运是因为欧洲人带来了先进的技术, 思想和政治体制, 对于其他落后的地区而言这些舶来品至少在看起来肯定是会帮助本地的社会向前进步的。说不幸是因为西方的影响(特别是武器, 行政体制和经济手段)将会完全打断这些地方自发的历史进程(主要是指封建化进程, 太过落后的那就无所谓打不打断了, 这样的地方产生文明都异常困难)。因为在这些影响下, 中央政府相对于地方的力量大大增加了。这样我们就看到了一个怪异的现象, 全世界大片地区处于一种“伪近代化”的状态, 国家的权力正在增强, 但是整个社会却没有经历过完整封建阶段的重组, 支持近现代文明的基本体制和意识形态根本无从谈起。国家基础权力的增长催生了更强的专制权力(反正没办法限制), 社会并不存在接纳现代科学思想的条件, 这些国家难以在科技进步上追上西方的步伐, 独裁者就会更加倾向于扩大剥削来增加自己能够控制的力量。

例如我们可以明显看到莫卧儿帝国和奥斯曼帝国发生的事情, 尽管封建化根本没有到达应有的顶点, 也就是中世纪欧洲的那种封建体制。但是随着 16 世纪西方影响的日益显著, 这两个帝国的封建化都出现了退潮。在莫卧儿帝国的阿克巴皇帝(Akbar)统治时期, 一种名为曼萨布达尔制(Mansabdar 指的 mansab 的拥有者)的官僚等级制度出现了, 大约有 33 个等级的曼萨布达尔。虽然从理论上说, 曼萨布达尔仍然会被授予贾吉尔(现在被称为曼萨巴 mansab), 但是曼萨布达尔制在本质上已经变成了一种官僚等级制度, 不同等级的曼萨布达尔拥有不同的权力、地位和收入, 相比之下原先伊克塔持有者的等级划分通常与提供军事服务的规模相关。之前在德里苏丹国时期发展出的贾吉尔达可以世袭的规则在曼萨布达尔制下被取消了, 莫卧儿皇帝有权力加封, 减封或者全部没收曼萨布达尔的曼萨巴, 他直接控制着所有这些曼萨布达尔贵族。

在奥斯曼帝国出现了一种被称为蒂马尔(Timar)的封建军事采邑制度, 由骑兵武士西帕希(Spahi)领有。完全相似地, 蒂马尔不允许世袭, 土地的所有权属于苏丹, 下赐的不过是收益权。不过蒂马尔的拥有者可以聘请专业人员来协助管理领地, 因为他们有一定的行政管理权, 也行使部分警察权。如果治理得当使得土地和人口增加就会获得奖励, 如果土地抛荒就会受到惩罚, 这就使西帕希的个人荣辱与自己治理的土地有了更深的联系。站在这个角度上说, 或许奥斯曼的封建化程度要比莫卧儿稍高一些, 不过在本质上确实没什么区别。奥斯曼苏丹也可以随时收回和重新分配土地, 并且采取一套十分复杂的监督制度对于蒂马尔进行调查和分发, 奥斯曼帝国已经高度官僚化了。萨菲帝国(Safavid)的情况从总体上看与它的两个同行没有区别, 西方学者也喜欢把这三个政权化为一类。

“伪近代化”问题在我看来依然是当代社会最为严重的国际问题没有之一, 任何人只要在地图上勾勒出发达国家和地区的全部版图就完全不难发现这一点: 无非是欧洲国家, 日本, 地理大发现时期形成的殖民地。近代化的基础是欧洲一千年中世纪所经过的封建制度的整个发展过程所锤炼出的制度、组织、公约和观念。对于其他所有没有走完整个封建进程的国家来说, 他们有什么办法在现有条件下把缺的课给补上呢? 毕竟今天这个年代不可能再让那些落后的国家把封建化进程重走一遍。迄今为止全世界没有人提出过令人满意的方案。不过我在这里应该指出的是, 我国不属于亚非国家中普遍因为西方影响的出现变得“不幸”的国家, 对于印度和土耳其而言, 如果我们假设欧洲的影响从来不曾存在, 那么再给他们两个国家一定时间, 从历史趋势上看封建化进程继续发展是极大概率的事。中国不一样, 中国变成一个稳定的官僚复辟国家的时间远在西方人的影响到来之前, 这属于自己早早自杀了, 别人能做的只有鞭尸, 没人能再把它杀一遍。如果说什么使得已经极度不幸的中国人变得更加不幸的话, 那也只能是苏俄而非一般意义上的西方国家。